

Beethoven, Symphony No. 5 in C minor, op. 67 — i, mm. 1–5

Schenkerian graph of the opening motto

The Schenkerian graph illustrates the opening motto of Beethoven's Symphony No. 5 in C minor, op. 67, measures 1–5. The graph is organized into four staves, each representing a different layer of the musical structure:

- Fg. (Foreground):** The top staff shows the actual musical notation. It begins with a treble clef and a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody consists of a quarter rest, followed by a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note C5, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note G4, and a half note F4. The first four notes are grouped by a slur, and the last four notes are grouped by a slur. Above the first four notes are the Roman numerals V, III, IV, and II. Above the last four notes are the Roman numerals IV, II, and I.
- Mg. (Middle Ground):** The second staff shows the middle ground. It begins with a treble clef and a key signature of two flats. The melody consists of a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note C5, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note G4, and a half note F4. The first four notes are grouped by a slur, and the last four notes are grouped by a slur. Above the first four notes are the Roman numerals V, III, IV, and II. Above the last four notes are the Roman numerals IV, II, and I.
- Bg. (Background):** The third staff shows the background. It begins with a treble clef and a key signature of two flats. The melody consists of a quarter note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note C5, a quarter note B-flat4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note G4, and a half note F4. The first four notes are grouped by a slur, and the last four notes are grouped by a slur. Above the first four notes are the Roman numerals V, III, IV, and II. Above the last four notes are the Roman numerals IV, II, and I.
- Bottom Staff:** The bottom staff shows the bass line. It begins with a bass clef and a key signature of two flats. The melody consists of a quarter note G3, a quarter note A3, a quarter note B-flat3, a quarter note C4, a quarter note B-flat3, a quarter note A3, a quarter note G3, and a half note F3. The first four notes are grouped by a slur, and the last four notes are grouped by a slur. Above the first four notes are the Roman numerals V, III, IV, and II. Above the last four notes are the Roman numerals IV, II, and I.